

with Alexa, IFTT and SmartThings. Another variant of the WeMo switch is the Belkin WeMo Insight Switch, which has one additional functionality that is very useful in monitoring energy consumption – you can “monitor your electronics and send information about the device’s energy usage directly to your smartphone or tablet”. In addition, the size of the Insight is comparably less than the normal Switch, which prevents the blocking up of other outlets near the switch. The Insight does come at a premium cost of ₹4500, but if you have a budget that allows you to splurge on such a device, you should definitely consider this one.

There’s also the iDevices smart switch, that would cost you ₹3800, but doesn’t need the presence of an external hub, and can be controlled from your iPhone/iPad. If you plan on using Apple’s HomeKit environment to develop your automation system, you should definitely give this one a shot. Other devices that would function similarly would be the Samsung SmartThings switch. It does come for a hefty ₹7500, and needs the SmartThings hub to function.

Or A Smart Bulb!

After all these, if you’re still looking for more customisable lighting that can be adjusted to your mood, season and timing, you should consider looking at smart light bulbs. The most popular option that has been vetted by reviewers across the world is Philips Hue, a smart light bulb that uses a central bridge/hub to control the light bulbs. The Hub needs to be connected to a router, following which you’ll need to download the Philips Hue app on your smartphone to make use of the lights. The app will allow you to control the lighting, in terms of colour, hue and lumen, and it’ll allow you to brighten and dim the lights from your smartphone. The bulbs can show up to 16 million colours and shades of white, and you can create customisable palettes and scenes to adjust the lighting. And there’s a lot more non-traditional things you can do with these bulbs, like using them as your personal alarm clock that change colours at the programmed time you set them for, or just having them switch on and off at any programmed or random time. In fact, the Hue is compatible with SmartThings, Nest and Alexa. However, you need to spend almost ₹12,500 to get hold of these babies, so you might want to hold off on this and purchase more traditional lighting systems with remotely controlled switches. You can take a look at Philips Lux, the white-only version of the Hue, that costs half the amount that the latter does, but you’ll miss out on the ability to change colours and have different scenes set.